Assignment 04: The Portfolio Contact Desk

100L · SEMESTER 1 · WEEK 07: HTML II — FORMS, SEMANTICS & ACCESSIBILITY · INDIVIDUAL TAKE-HOME · 10 POINTS · ABOUT 2 HOURS

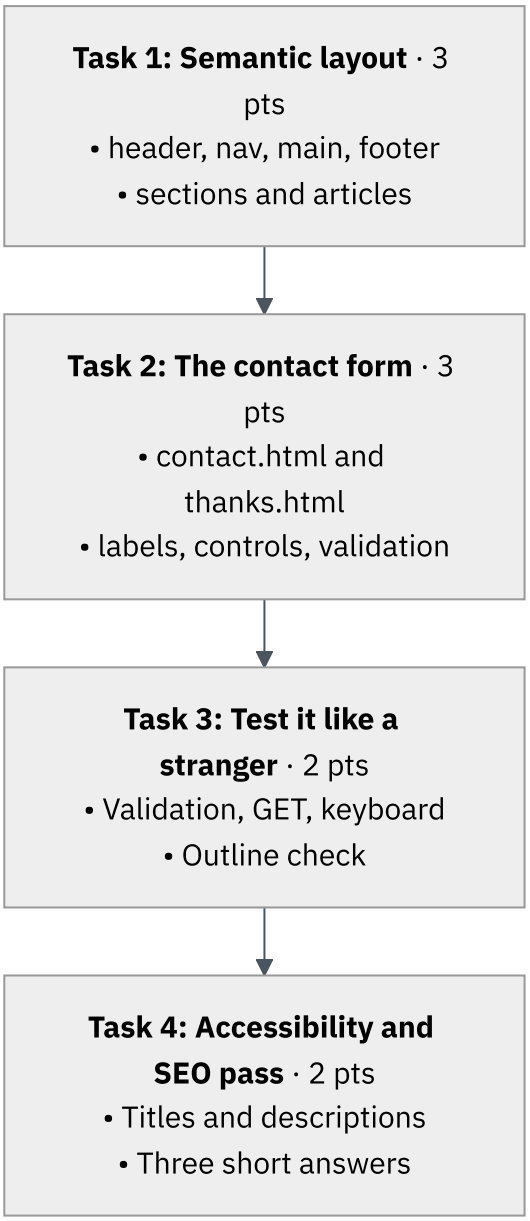
Your portfolio can show people what you've built, but it can't hear back from them. In this assignment you give it a **front desk**: a semantic layout that every visitor (and every screen reader and search engine) can find their way around, and a **contact form** that checks its answers before they are sent.

This is the Week 7 curriculum deliverable:

> **"Add a contact form and semantic layout to the portfolio."**

You started it in class (Level 3 of the exercises). Here you finish it, test it like a stranger, and hand it in. It's still **HTML only**: no CSS until Week 8.

Mission Roadmap



Before You Start

IMPORTANT

Your own work, unaided. This is 100L: no AI tool may write, complete, check or fix any part of this assignment, and VS Code's AI features stay switched off. Use your Week 7 class notes, the references below, and your tutor. Talk ideas through with classmates if you like, but type every line yourself, in your own words.

Work in your Week 6 `portfolio` folder. It keeps growing all semester, and goes on GitHub in Week 11. When you finish, it should look like this:

```
portfolio/
├── index.html      updated: semantic layout (Task 1)
├── contact.html    new: the contact form (Task 2)
├── thanks.html     new: where the form goes (Task 2)
├── hello.html      from Week 6
└── images/         from Week 6
```

> **TIP**
> **Missed Week 6, or lost your folder?** Create a fresh `portfolio` folder with an `index.html` that has an `h1` with your name, and at least three `h2` sections about you. Tell your tutor, then carry on.

Task 1: Semantic Layout · 3 points

> **NOTE**
> **The Mental Model:** A page is a building. `header` is the entrance, `nav` the signboard, `main` the rooms, `footer` the back office. Landmarks don't change the look: they tell browsers, screen readers and search engines what each area is *for*.

Update `index.html` so that:

PART	REQUIREMENT
`header`	Holds your `h1` (your name, or the name you want employers to see) and the `nav`
`nav`	A `ul` of links: at least one jump link to a section of this page, and a link to `contact.html`
`main`	Exactly **one**. Holds everything unique to this page
`sections`	At least three, each with its own `h2` and a unique `id`
`articles`	Each thing you've built (your Week 5 page, your Week 6 page, any other) is its own `article`, with an `h3`, a sentence or two about it, and a link to it
`footer`	Your name and the current year, plus one more line of your choice

Then give `contact.html` and `thanks.html` the **same** `header`, `nav` and `footer`, so visitors can move between your pages from any of them.

> **WARNING**
> **Keep your Week 6 structure.** Wrapping content in landmarks should not delete anything. Your headings, lists, image, table and links from last week all stay, now inside the right regions.

Task 2: The Contact Form · 3 points

On `contact.html`, inside `main`, build a form that a visitor would use to get in touch with you.

CONTROL	REQUIREMENT
Name	`text`, required, at least 2 characters
Email	`email`, required
Reason for getting in touch	Either a `select` (with an empty first option) or a group of at least three `radio` buttons in a `fieldset` with a `legend`. Required. You choose the reasons.
How did you find me?	At least two `checkbox`es in a `fieldset` with a `legend`. Not required.
Message	`textarea`, required, with a `maxlength` you choose
One more control of your choice	Any other input type from the class notes (`number`, `date`, `tel`…), with a validation rule that suits it
Send	A `button` with `type="submit"` and clear text, such as *Send message*

And these rules for the whole form:

1. Every control has a real `<label>`, connected with `for` and `id`, or by wrapping.
2. Every control that sends an answer has a `name`.
3. The form uses `method="get"` and `action="thanks.html"`.
4. `thanks.html` thanks the visitor and links back to `index.html`.

> **CAUTION**
> **A placeholder is not a label.** It vanishes as soon as typing starts, and assistive technologies don't all treat it as a label. Use `placeholder` only for an example, if at all. And never put your real phone number, home address or matric number in the form or the page.

Task 3: Test It Like a Stranger · 2 points

Run each test and record it in a **test log**: what you did · what you expected · what happened.

1. **Validation test.** Break each rule once: an empty required field, a 1-character name, an email without `@`, no reason chosen, and your own control's rule. Write down the exact message the browser shows each time. Screenshot **two** of them.
2. **GET test.** Fill in the whole form, including a message with a comma and an `&`, and send it. Screenshot `thanks.html` with the **address bar** showing. In your log, copy the query string and circle each `name=value` pair and each encoded character.
3. **Keyboard test.** Put the mouse away. Starting from the address bar, use only Tab, Shift+Tab, arrow keys, Space and Enter to fill in and send the form. Note any control you couldn't reach, and whether you could always see where you were.
4. **Outline test.** Write down every heading on `index.html`, in order, with its level, and every landmark (`header`, `nav`, `main`, `section`, `article`, `footer`). Does it read like a sensible map of the page?

Optional: turn on your device's screen reader (see Module 6 of the class notes), Tab through your form, and note what it says for one control. **Optional, online:** check each page with the W3C validator's Validate by direct input tab and record the number of errors.

Task 4: Accessibility and SEO Pass · 2 points

A. FINISH THE HEAD OF EVERY PAGE

On `index.html`, `contact.html` and `thanks.html`:

1. A **unique** `<title>` that says what the page is, such as *Contact · Ada Obi*.
2. A `<meta name="description">` of one or two sentences, written for a person reading search results.
3. `<html lang="en">` and `<meta charset="UTF-8">` still in place.

Also check that every image has a meaningful `alt`, and that no link says only *click here*.

B. ANSWER THREE QUESTIONS

Two or three sentences each, in your own words. Point to your own code.

1. In your form, choose one control. What do its `id` and its `name` each do?
2. Why did you choose a `select` or radio buttons for the reason, and checkboxes for *How did you find me?*
3. Your form uses `method="get"`. Name one kind of form that should use `post` instead, and explain why.

> **IMPORTANT**
> Be ready to open your portfolio in class, send your form, and explain any element without your notes. Work you can't explain earns no marks for that criterion.

Rookie Traps to Avoid

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT HAPPENED	HOW TO FIX IT
An answer is missing from the query string	That control has no `name`	Add a `name` to every control that sends an answer
Clicking a label doesn't focus its box	`for` and `id` don't match exactly	Copy the `id` into the `for`
Several reasons stay selected at once	The radio buttons have different `name`s	Give the whole group one `name`
The query string shows `reason=Choose…`	The `select`'s first option has no `value=""`	Add `value=""` to the first option
Sending opens *Your file couldn't be accessed*	`action` names a file that doesn't exist or is misspelt	Check `thanks.html` is in the same folder, spelt the same way
Your footer text appears inside the message box	`<textarea>` was never closed	Add `</textarea>`

Submit

Submit on **Google Classroom**, under *Assignment 04 — The Portfolio Contact Desk*, by the due date shown there.

1. **Your website:** zip the whole `portfolio` folder. Name it `assignment-04-<surname>-<firstname>.zip`.
2. **Your evidence:** one PDF named `assignment-04-<surname>-<firstname>-evidence.pdf`, in this order:
   - The Task 3 test log, with the two validation screenshots and the GET screenshot
   - Your outline from the Task 3 outline test
   - Your three Task 4 answers

   If you can't make a PDF, attach the photos and screenshots as separate images, numbered in order (`assignment-04-<surname>-<firstname>-1.jpg`, `-2.jpg`, ...).
3. Click **Turn in**. Keep working in your `portfolio` folder: it's the base for Week 8.

> **NOTE**
> **No internet?** Save everything on your computer and hand it to your tutor on a USB stick, or hand in the paper logs. Ask the tutor to record that they received it. Late connectivity never cancels work you finished on time.

Marking · 10 points

CRITERION	POINTS	WHAT EARNS FULL MARKS
1. Semantic layout	3	`header` with `h1` and `nav`; exactly one `main`; a `footer` (1). Three or more `section`s, each with a heading and unique `id`; each project in its own `article` (1). The same header, nav and footer on all three pages, with working links between them (1)
2. Contact form	3	Every control required by Task 2 is present and of the right type, with `fieldset` and `legend` for grouped choices (1). Every control has a connected `label` and a `name` (1). Validation rules match the brief, and the form sends with GET to a working `thanks.html` (1)
3. Testing	2	Validation and GET tests recorded with screenshots and the query string explained (1). Keyboard and outline tests recorded honestly, including anything that didn't work (1)
4. Accessibility, SEO and explanations	2	Unique titles, descriptions, `lang`, meaningful `alt` and descriptive link text on all pages (1). Three answers in your own words that match your code (1)
Total	**10**	

Styling is not marked. Any criterion you can't explain when asked in class earns no marks. If a device problem stopped you, tell your tutor before the deadline: that criterion stays pending until you have had a fair turn on a working machine.

📚 References

- Week 7 class notes — Every element and test in this assignment, with examples.
- MDN: Structuring documents — Landmarks, with a full example page.
- MDN: How to structure a web form — Labels, `fieldset` and `legend`.
- MDN: Client-side form validation — Read up to "Validating forms using JavaScript".
- MDN: Sending form data — GET, POST and the query string.
- MDN: What's in the head? — `title`, `meta description` and `lang`.

SOURCES

- Programme curriculum §4, Week 07 (HTML II — Forms, Semantics & Accessibility). Deliverable: "Add a contact form and semantic layout to the portfolio".
- All tasks are original. Links checked 14 November 2026.